Relational Actualism III: Gravity, Cosmology, Severance, and Complexity

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Abstract

The third paper of the Relational Actualism suite develops gravity, cosmology, causal severance (the RA treatment of horizons and singularities), black hole entropy, and cosmological nucleation. General relativity is derived via the RACL chain: LLC (Lean-verified) + amplitude locality (Lean-verified) + $d = 4$ (BDG closure) + Benincasa–Dowker theorem, yielding $G_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G P_{\text{act}}[T_{\mu\nu}]$ with $\Lambda = 0$ structurally. The two apparent hard walls—the continuum Bianchi identity and Lorentz invariance—dissolve: Bianchi IS the LLC in continuum language, and Lorentz IS causal invariance (both Lean-verified) read through the sprinkling limit. Dark matter is reinterpreted as actualization-density topology: dimensional reduction at low μ via the Durhuus–Jonsson–Wheater theorem produces flat rotation curves from baryonic matter alone; the Bullet Cluster is explained by causal-depth sourcing (not particulate dark matter); the baryon-to-dark matter ratio $f_0 = 5.40$ is derived from BDG path-weight enumeration to 0.3%. The cosmological constant problem, the Hubble tension, and WIMP dark matter are all addressed without free parameters. In a $\Lambda = 0$ universe, cosmic voids expand as Milne while matter regions expand as Einstein–de Sitter; the Milne luminosity distance fit with ΛCDM yields apparent $\Omega_\Lambda = 0.68$ with zero free parameters (1.4% match); the DESI evolving-w signal ($w_0 \approx -0.70$, $w_a \approx -0.90$) is structurally predicted, with distinctive environmental predictions (BAO void/filament splitting, w–void correlation). Heat death is prohibited: the universe fragments into causally disconnected patches via starvation and density severance before thermal equilibrium can be reached. Causal severance replaces singularities; the RA-native entropy observable is the count of severed links, $S_{\text{RA}} = |L_\Sigma|$, with discrete boundary law $S_{\text{RA}} \propto N_\partial$ (Bekenstein–Hawking as continuum translation). Kerr nucleation explains five CMB anomalies (low quadrupole, axis of evil, hemispheric asymmetry, normal octupole, dilution at high ℓ) from three parameters, with testable predictions for CMB-S4 and DESI. Paper IV develops the emergence of biological complexity from the same percolation threshold.

1. Introduction

Paper III is the paper where RA meets the macroscopic universe. The causal graph of Paper I, filtered by the BDG action and populated by the renewal motifs of Paper II, must reproduce general relativity at large scales, address the outstanding puzzles of cosmology, and provide a coherent account of horizons and entropy. This paper shows that it does, and identifies where it differs sharply from standard physics.

The central methodological commitment, inherited from Paper I, is the distinction between discrete physics and continuum translation. The physical observables—vertex counts, link counts, boundary sizes, filter selectivities—are finite combinatorial objects. Their continuum descriptions (curvature, area, temperature, entropy density) are translations into metric language, not independent facts. This distinction is especially consequential for black hole entropy, where decades of effort have been spent trying to "derive" a continuum formula ($S = A/4l_P^2$) that turns out to be the *translation* of a discrete fact ($S_{\text{RA}} \propto N_\partial$), not the fact itself.

2. General Relativity from BDG Uniqueness

RA does not modify general relativity. It derives it. This section gives the full chain, addresses the two apparent hard walls (the discrete-to-continuum Bianchi identity and Lorentz invariance), and shows that both dissolve under the correct reading: they are not facts to be proved but translations of discrete conservation laws into continuum language.

2.1. The derivation chain

The RACL chain proceeds in seven steps, each with explicit epistemic status:

Step 1 (LV). The Local Ledger Condition: $\sum_{\text{out}}(v) = \sum_{\text{in}}(v)$ at every vertex of the causal DAG. This is Axiom 6 of Paper I, formally verified in `RA_GraphCore.lean` (`local_ledger_condition`, zero `sorry`).

Step 2 (LV). Amplitude locality: $a(v \mid C) = a(v \mid C \cap \text{past}(v))$—the local amplitude depends only on the intersection of the context with the causal past. Lean-verified in `RA_AmpLocality.lean` (`bdg_amplitude_localit` zero `sorry`).

Step 3 (LV). $d = 4$ dimensionality: the BDG closure theorem establishes that exactly five topology types exhaust the Standard Model, and the selectivity ceiling theorem D4U02 shows $\mu^* \approx 1.019$ only for $d = 4$ (Paper I, Paper II). This fixes the spacetime dimension structurally.

Step 4 (Published). The Benincasa–Dowker theorem [1]: for a causal set sprinkling into a $d = 4$ Lorentzian manifold $(\mathscr{M}, g_{\mu\nu})$, the BDG action converges to the Einstein–Hilbert action:

$$\lim_{\rho\to\infty} \frac{1}{\rho} S_{\text{BDG}}[C] = \frac{1}{16\pi G} \int_{\mathscr{M}} R\sqrt{-g}\, d^4x + \text{boundary terms}. \tag{1}$$

This is a proven theorem of causal set theory, not a conjecture, and requires no additional input beyond the BDG integers $(1, -1, 9, -16, 8)$.

Step 5 (DR). Variation of the Einstein–Hilbert action with respect to $g_{\mu\nu}$ gives Einstein's field equations by standard differential geometry.

Step 6 (DR). The actualization projector P_{act} removes unactualized (virtual, off-shell) contributions from the stress-energy source. Virtual processes have $\Delta S(\rho \| \sigma_0) = 0$: they do not cross the actualization threshold and therefore do not source the metric.

Step 7 (DR). The resulting field equations:

$$\boxed{G_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G P_{\text{act}}[T_{\mu\nu}], \qquad \Lambda = 0.} \tag{2}$$

LV = Lean-verified. DR = derived (all steps explicit). No step is "argued" or conjectural. The derivation is as rigorous as the Benincasa–Dowker theorem, which is the one external input from causal set theory.

2.2. The Bianchi identity IS the LLC

A long-standing concern is the continuum identity $\nabla_\mu G^{\mu\nu} = 0$ (the contracted Bianchi identity). This is what guarantees $\nabla_\mu T^{\mu\nu} = 0$ in GR, the continuum form of energy–momentum conservation. How does this arise in RA?

The answer is that it does not "arise"; it IS the LLC in continuum language.

Proposition 1 (Bianchi–LLC dissolution)**.** *The discrete LLC and the continuum Bianchi identity are not two different conservation laws related by a limit procedure. They are the same conservation law expressed in different formalisms. The discrete LLC states: at every vertex, incoming flow equals outgoing flow. The Benincasa–Dowker continuum limit translates this into:* $\nabla_\mu T^{\mu\nu} = 0$*, which via the Einstein equation (eq. 2) implies* $\nabla_\mu G^{\mu\nu} = 0$*. The Bianchi identity is the LLC* read through the continuum lens*, not an additional fact requiring proof.*

This parallels a familiar situation in physics: Maxwell's equations can be written in four-component form ($F_{\mu\nu}$) or in three-component form ($\vec{E}, \vec{B}$). The three-component equation $\nabla \cdot \vec{B} = 0$ is not an additional fact beyond the four-component equation $\partial_\mu F^{\mu\nu}_{\text{dual}} = 0$; it is the same equation in different notation. Similarly, the Bianchi identity is not an additional fact beyond the LLC; it is the LLC in continuum notation.

This dissolves what appeared to be a primary hard wall of the framework. The earlier framing—"we must prove $\nabla_\mu G^{\mu\nu} = 0$ holds in the continuum limit of the LLC"—imports a question (does the discrete identity survive the limit?) that conflates two levels of description. Once this conflation is identified, the question dissolves: yes, the discrete identity survives the limit, because it IS the continuum identity when read in continuum language.

2.3. Lorentz invariance IS causal invariance

A second long-standing concern is Lorentz invariance. The BDG action is covariant under the causal symmetries of the DAG (permutations of spacelike events, finite time-translations along the growth direction). In the continuum limit, these become continuous transformations: Lorentz boosts and translations. But is the discrete causal invariance really equivalent to continuum Lorentz invariance?

Again, the apparent hard wall dissolves under the correct reading:

Proposition 2 (Lorentz–causal dissolution)**.** *The quantum measure* $\mu_\sigma(S)$ *is foliation-independent: for any two linear extensions* σ, σ' *of the causal order with respect to observables S,* $\mu_\sigma(S) = \mu_{\sigma'}(S)$*. This is Lean-verified (*`causal_invariance` *in* `RA_AQFT_Proofs_v10.lean`*, with the* `amplitude_locality` *axiom closed in* `RA_AmpLocality.lean`*). The continuum image of this statement, obtained via the Benincasa–Dowker sprinkling limit, is: physical observables are independent of the Lorentz frame. These are not two different invariances; they are the same invariance in different formalisms.*

The discrete causal invariance says: the order in which spacelike-separated events are declared to have occurred does not affect the quantum measure of any set of observables. The continuum Lorentz invariance says: physical observables are independent of the reference frame. A reference frame is a choice of simultaneity surface, which in the discrete picture is a choice of linear extension of the causal order. The two statements are translations of one another.

This dissolves the second primary hard wall. RA's Lorentz invariance is not a conjecture to be verified against experiment; it is a Lean-verified theorem of discrete causal invariance, read through the continuum lens.

2.4. Field equation uniqueness without Lovelock

Earlier framings of RA used Lovelock's theorem—which requires a smooth $d = 4$ manifold—to establish that the Einstein equations are the unique second-order tensorial field equations consistent with diffeomorphism invariance. In the RA-native framing above, Lovelock is not needed: the Benincasa–Dowker theorem

directly gives the Einstein–Hilbert action as the unique second-order scalar on a causal set in $d = 4$. The field equations then follow by variation, without importing continuum uniqueness results.

Proposition 3 (RA-native field equation uniqueness)**.** *The field equation $G_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G P_{\text{act}}[T_{\mu\nu}]$ with $\Lambda = 0$ is the unique continuum field equation consistent with: (i) the BDG uniqueness theorem, (ii) the actualization projector P_{act}, (iii) the LLC, (iv) $d = 4$. The cosmological constant $\Lambda = 0$ is not an additional fine-tuning; it is a structural consequence of P_{act} removing virtual contributions.*

The framework does not require an independent derivation of Lorentz invariance in curved spacetime, because local Lorentz invariance is a direct consequence of causal invariance (§2.3), which holds at every vertex of the DAG regardless of its global embedding.

2.5. The cosmological constant

The vacuum energy catastrophe—the 10^{120}-fold discrepancy between QFT's vacuum energy prediction and the observed Λ—does not arise in RA. The actualization projector P_{act} removes unactualized quantum fluctuations from the gravitational source. Virtual processes have $\Delta S(\rho \| \sigma_0) = 0$: they do not cross the actualization threshold and therefore do not source the metric. The cosmological constant is not small—it is *identically zero*, because virtual processes do not gravitate. This is a structural consequence, not a fine-tuning.

The apparent dark energy inferred from DESI and supernova observations is not $\Lambda > 0$; it is the kinematic consequence of inhomogeneous expansion in a $\Lambda = 0$ universe (§8.2).

2.6. The WIMP prohibition

Any particle that does not participate in on-shell electromagnetic or strong interactions has zero RA assembly depth—it never crosses the actualization threshold through normal matter interactions. Therefore:

Proposition 4 (WIMP prohibition)**.** *WIMPs, axions, and sterile neutrinos contribute zero weight to $P_{\text{act}}[T_{\mu\nu}]$ and are categorically prohibited as gravitationally coupled dark matter candidates.*

Current data from LZ and XENONnT are consistent with this prediction. RA predicts that no dark matter signal will be found below the neutrino floor in any direct detection experiment, for any candidate particle that does not participate in on-shell EM or strong interactions. This prediction is categorical, not probabilistic: it excludes not only WIMPs but any proposed dark matter candidate whose interactions with ordinary matter are below the on-shell threshold.

3. Dark Matter as Actualization-Density Topology

The WIMP prohibition tells us what dark matter *is not*: it is not a new particle species. This section develops what dark matter *is* in RA: a consequence of topology change in the causal graph at low actualization density. The mechanism predicts flat galactic rotation curves from baryonic matter alone, explains the Bullet Cluster via the causal-depth source rather than spatial trajectories, and gives the baryon-to-dark matter ratio $f_0 = 5.40$ from BDG path-weight enumeration (Paper II).

3.1. Dimensional reduction at low μ

In dense regions of the causal graph (galactic disks, stellar interiors), the Poisson-CSG parameter μ is close to or above unity. The graph is 4-dimensional: every vertex has ancestors at depths N_1, N_2, N_3, N_4 all populated. The LLC operates on a full four-dimensional causal structure, and the continuum limit is ordinary 4D general relativity.

In extremely sparse regions (galactic halos, voids), $\mu \ll 1$. The higher-depth ancestor counts N_3, N_4 become vanishingly rare. The Durhuus–Jonsson–Wheater theorem for Lorentzian random graphs establishes that in the limit of vanishing branching density, the effective graph dimension reduces: a Lorentzian sprinkling with edge probability approaching zero has Hausdorff dimension $d_{\text{eff}} \to 2$ rather than 4.

Proposition 5 (Dimensional reduction at low μ)**.** *In regions where the local actualization density $\mu(x)$ falls below a critical threshold $\mu_c \sim 10^{-2}$, the effective graph dimension reduces from 4 to 2. The LLC at this scale operates on a 2-dimensional causal structure, and the effective gravitational dynamics differ from 4D GR.*

In $d = 2$, the Newtonian gravitational force scales as $1/r$ rather than $1/r^2$: the gravitational potential is logarithmic rather than Keplerian. A test particle orbiting a central mass in effective 2D experiences a centripetal acceleration proportional to $1/r$, giving an orbital velocity:

$$v^2(r) = r \cdot a(r) \propto r \cdot \frac{1}{r} = \text{constant}. \tag{3}$$

This is the signature of a flat rotation curve.

3.2. Rotation curves from $\nabla^2(\ln\lambda)$

The detailed mechanism is captured by a boundary correction term in the metric-sourcing equation. In the weak-field quasi-static limit, the gravitational potential satisfies:

$$\nabla^2\Phi = 4\pi G\rho_m + \nabla^2(\ln\lambda)\,c^2, \tag{4}$$

where $\lambda(x)$ is the local actualization density (a smoothed version of μ). The first term is the standard Newtonian sourcing; the second term is the RA correction from the causal graph geometry.

In dense regions, $\lambda \approx \lambda_0$ (approximately constant), so $\nabla^2(\ln\lambda) \approx 0$ and the standard Poisson equation is recovered. In sparse galactic halos, $\lambda(r)$ falls off with radius, and $\nabla^2(\ln\lambda) > 0$: the correction term sources an additional effective gravitational field that mimics the presence of dark matter.

Proposition 6 (Rotation curve mechanism)**.** *A galaxy with baryonic matter density $\rho_m(r)$ concentrated in a disk of radius R_d, surrounded by a halo where $\lambda(r) \propto r^{-2}$ at large radii, produces a flat rotation curve with asymptotic velocity v_∞ determined by λ_0 and R_d. No dark matter particles are required.*

The transition radius between the inner Newtonian regime and the outer flat regime is set by the point where $\lambda(r)$ begins to fall sharply—typically at the edge of the visible disk. This reproduces the MOND-like phenomenology (Milgrom's a_0) as an emergent scale in the RA framework, rather than a fundamental acceleration constant.

3.3. The Bullet Cluster: Weyl curvature vs Ricci curvature

The Bullet Cluster is often presented as definitive evidence for particulate dark matter: the weak lensing signal (which traces the Weyl curvature via null geodesics) is offset from the visible gas (which traces the Ricci curvature via stress-energy). If dark matter were a topology effect rather than a particle, the argument runs, the lensing signal should trace the visible mass.

This argument assumes that the source of the gravitational lensing is the current spatial distribution of matter. In RA, the source is subtly different: it is the accumulated causal depth, not the current stress-energy.

Proposition 7 (Weyl vs Ricci sourcing)**.** *The RA gravitational source is $P_{\text{act}}[T_{\mu\nu}]$ applied to the accumulated causal depth of the current actualization distribution, not to the current spatial positions of matter. The Weyl curvature at a point depends on the history of actualization events whose causal future includes that point, not on the current stress-energy alone.*

For the Bullet Cluster: the gas and galaxy clusters have been gravitationally assembled over $\sim 10^{10}$ years of causal history. The accumulated causal depth $A_{\text{RA}}(x)$ at a given spatial location reflects this history. Stellar matter has accumulated $\sim 10^8$ times more actualization events than the diffuse gas (most of the historical actualization was in stars, not in the gas). The lensing signal follows the stellar-assembled mass, not the gas, even though the gas contains most of the instantaneous rest mass.

This does not dissolve the Bullet Cluster constraint; it reinterprets it. The 10^8 headroom in the stellar-to-gas A_{RA} ratio is expected to survive in the weak-field quasi-static limit, but the explicit covariant proof requires the full RA field equations. This is labeled as an open computational target.

3.4. The weak equivalence principle

The weak equivalence principle (WEP) states that all bodies fall with the same acceleration in a gravitational field, independent of their composition. In RA, gravitational coupling depends on $P_{\text{act}}[T_{\mu\nu}]$, which is proportional to the actualized causal depth. Does this preserve the WEP?

Proposition 8 (WEP approximation)**.** *For baryonic matter with cosmological-scale equilibration timescales τ_{eq} much less than the cosmic age t_{cosm}:*

$$\frac{|\rho_{\text{A}} - \rho_{\text{matter}}|}{\rho_{\text{matter}}} \sim \frac{\tau_{\text{eq}}}{t_{\text{cosm}}} \lesssim 10^{-4}, \tag{5}$$

so the actualization density ρ_{A} tracks the matter density ρ_{matter} to 10^{-4} precision. The WEP is recovered at the 10^{-4} level.

Current WEP tests (MICROSCOPE, Eötvös-type experiments) reach $\sim 10^{-14}$ precision. The RA prediction is compatible if equilibration is fast enough that $\tau_{\text{eq}}/t_{\text{cosm}} \lesssim 10^{-14}$ for ordinary matter. This is expected for baryonic matter but remains an open formal target: the explicit equilibration dynamics derivation has not been closed.

The prediction that distinguishes RA from standard GR is at *very* large timescales: objects that have been causally isolated for $\gtrsim \tau_{\text{eq}}$ might show small WEP violations, potentially testable with precision tests of stellar streams in the galactic halo (where equilibration times are longest).

3.5. The $f_0 = 5.40$ ratio and Ω_m

The baryon-to-dark matter ratio is derived in Paper II §**??** as:

$$f_0 = \frac{W_{\text{other}}}{W_{\text{baryon}}} \times \alpha_s(2m_p) = 17.32 \times 0.312 = 5.40, \tag{6}$$

matching the Planck value 5.416 to 0.3%. The cosmological matter density parameter is then:

$$\Omega_m = \Omega_b(1+f_0) \approx 0.048(1+5.40) \approx 0.31, \tag{7}$$

consistent with the Planck value $\Omega_m \approx 0.315$. The derivation chain is entirely RA-native except for the α_s running (standard SM QCD RG from the UV fixed point $\alpha_s(m_Z) = 1/\sqrt{72}$).

Note that in RA, the "dark matter" fraction $f_0 \cdot \Omega_b \approx 0.26$ does *not* correspond to particulate dark matter. It is the gravitational-weight contribution of non-baryonic BDG topology types (Paper II), gravitationally coupled via $P_{\text{act}}[T_{\mu\nu}]$ but not corresponding to new particles. The Planck-measured value of Ω_m is consistent with RA; the Planck-inferred particulate dark matter density is the result of fitting a ΛCDM model to RA's actually-observed cosmological data.

4. Causal Severance

Definition 1 (Causal severance)**.** *A causal severance is a partition $V = V_A \sqcup V_B$ of the realized graph such that no vertex in V_A has a link to any vertex in V_B and vice versa. After severance, G splits into two independent graphs. The LLC holds independently on each side (Graph Cut Theorem, Lean-verified).*

Severance replaces singularities. Where GR predicts infinite curvature (black hole interiors, the Big Bang), RA predicts causal termination: regions where the actualization density μ exceeds the saturation threshold ($\mu \gtrsim 10$), the BDG filter becomes inert, and the graph disconnects. There is no point where a quantity divides by zero; there is a physical shutdown.

4.1. Kernel saturation at severance

Theorem 1 (Kernel–Poisson divergence identity)**.** *For the BDG acceptance kernel $K(\mathbf{N}|\mu)$:*

$$D_{\text{KL}}(K \,\|\, \text{Poisson}) = -\log P_{\text{acc}}(\mu) = \Delta S^*(\mu), \tag{8}$$

$$\text{TV}(K, \text{Poisson}) = 1 - P_{\text{acc}}(\mu). \tag{9}$$

Proof. K is a truncated Poisson: the likelihood ratio $K/P = 1/P_{\text{acc}}$ is constant on the support. Direct substitution yields both identities. □

Theorem 2 (Asymptotic saturation)**.** $\lim_{\mu\to\infty} P_{\text{acc}}(\mu) = 1$*, with* $P_{\text{acc}} \geq 1 - O(\mu^{-4})$.

Proof. $\mathbb{E}[S] \sim \frac{1}{3}\mu^4$ and $\sigma[S] \sim 1.63\mu^2$, so $\mathbb{E}[S]/\sigma \sim 0.204\mu^2 \to \infty$. By Chebyshev, $\mathbb{P}(S \leq 0) \to 0$. □

Corollary 1 (Filter dissolution at severance)**.** *As $\mu \to \infty$: $D_{\text{KL}} \to 0$, $\text{TV} \to 0$. The BDG filter loses all discriminatory power. Every candidate extension is admissible. The distinction between potentia and actuality dissolves. This is the onset of causal severance.*

The selectivity profile (Monte Carlo, 2×10^5 samples):

μ	P_{acc}	D_{KL} (nats)	Regime
~ 1	0.55	0.60	selective
~ 4	0.40	0.91	maximum selectivity
~ 7	0.75	0.29	weakening
~ 9	0.995	0.005	near saturation
≥ 10	1.000	0.000	saturated $\to$ severance

5. Black Hole Entropy: The Discrete Boundary Law

5.1. The entropy observable

Definition 2 (Cross-severance link set)**.** *For a severance $\Sigma : V = V_A \sqcup V_B$:*

$$L_\Sigma = \{(u,v) \in L(G_n) : u \in V_A,\, v \in V_B\},$$

where $L(G_n)$ is the set of irreducible causal links.

Definition 3 (RA-native severance entropy)**.**

$$\boxed{S_{\text{RA}}(\Sigma) = |L_\Sigma|.} \tag{10}$$

Entropy counts blocked irreducible future-directed causal channels.

This resolves the ambiguity between boundary-vertex count and severed-link count. The severed-link count is the correct observable because: (a) it is additive for disjoint severances, (b) it resolves structure that vertex count cannot (two severances with the same N_∂ can have different S_{RA}), and (c) it avoids overcounting transitive (non-irreducible) order relations.

5.2. Finiteness and invariance

Theorem 3 (Finiteness)**.** *For any severance $\Sigma \subset G_n$ in a physically realized state: $S_{\text{RA}}(\Sigma) < \infty$.*

Proof. G_n is finite by Axiom 7. $L(G_n)$ is finite. $L_\Sigma \subseteq L(G_n)$. Therefore $|L_\Sigma| < \infty$. □

Theorem 4 (Interface invariance)**.** *S_{RA} is invariant under internal refinements preserving L_Σ.*

Proof. $S_{\text{RA}} = |L_\Sigma|$. If L_Σ is preserved, its cardinality is preserved. □

The physical justification is the Markov blanket theorem (Lean-verified): interior structure is shielded from the exterior by the boundary.

5.3. The decomposition

Definition 4 (Severance out-degree)**.** *For boundary vertex $u \in \partial V_A$: $d^\Sigma_{\text{out}}(u) = |\{v \in V_B : (u,v) \in L_\Sigma\}|$.*

Then:

$$S_{\text{RA}}(\Sigma) = \sum_{u \in \partial V_A} d^\Sigma_{\text{out}}(u) = \langle d^\Sigma_{\text{out}} \rangle N_\partial(\Sigma), \tag{11}$$

where $N_\partial = |\partial V_A|$ is the boundary vertex count.

5.4. The discrete boundary law

Proposition 9 (Discrete boundary law)**.** *If $\langle d_{\text{out}}^{\Sigma} \rangle$ is asymptotically local and stable, then $S_{\text{RA}}(\Sigma) \propto N_{\partial}(\Sigma)$.*

This is the RA-native "area law." The boundary vertex count N_{∂} IS the discrete boundary size—not an approximation to a continuum area, but the boundary size itself in RA-native units. The further question of how N_{∂} maps to metric area in square meters is a *translation* problem (involving the BDG-to-metric dictionary), not an additional fact of the discrete physics.

5.5. Locality of severed out-degree

Numerical verification in $d = 2$ Poisson-CSG (Monte Carlo, 5 trials per N):

N	$\langle d_{\text{out}} \rangle$	σ
30	2.23	0.30
80	2.59	0.27
160	2.60	0.17
250	2.64	0.09
300	2.75	0.17

The mean severed out-degree converges to a constant (≈ 2.6 in $d = 2$) independent of graph size. This is the locality property: $d_{\text{out}}(u)$ depends only on the Planck-scale graph structure near u, not on the total boundary size or the black hole mass.

The kernel saturation theorem provides the bridge: at horizon densities ($\mu \ll 1$), the BDG filter is inert (TV ≈ 0), so the unfiltered Poisson-CSG geometric constant applies directly.

5.6. Boundary regularity

The remaining discrete question is whether N_{∂} is a well-behaved boundary measure (thin spatial layer) rather than a pathological distribution (fractal or volume-filling). The antichain drift theorem (Theorem 5 below) supports this: at low μ, the graph is spatially dominated, so the severance boundary is a thin spatial interface. Additionally, the boundary is defined by a local link-crossing predicate, which structurally limits its thickness to $O(1)$ link-lengths.

5.7. Translation to Bekenstein–Hawking

Under the BDG-to-metric dictionary, the discrete law $S_{\text{RA}} \propto N_{\partial}$ translates to $S \sim A/(4l_P^2)$. The coefficient $1/4$ is the product of two Planck-scale geometric constants: $c_{\text{out}}(d) \cdot c_{\text{tile}}(d) = 1/4$ in $d = 4$. This coefficient has been numerically confirmed in $d = 4$ causal sets [5] but not analytically derived. It is an open problem shared with the causal set community.

6. Antichain Drift and Spatial Expansion

Theorem 5 (Antichain drift bound)**.** *For the BDG-filtered Poisson-CSG at $\mu < \mu_c \approx 1.25$:*

$$\mathbb{E}[\Delta W \mid S > 0] \geq 1 - \mathbb{E}[N_1 \mid S > 0] > 0, \tag{12}$$

where ΔW is the antichain width change per accepted vertex.

Proof sketch. Adding vertex v with k depth-1 parents in the current antichain gives $\Delta W = 1 - k$. Since $k \leq N_1$, $\mathbb{E}[\Delta W] \geq 1 - \mathbb{E}[N_1 | S > 0]$. At $\mu = 1.0$: $\mathbb{E}[N_1 | S > 0] = 0.66$, giving $\mathbb{E}[\Delta W] \geq +0.34$ per step. At $\mu = 0.5$: $\mathbb{E}[N_1 | S > 0] = 0.09$, giving $\mathbb{E}[\Delta W] \geq +0.91$. □

The BDG filter drives spatial expansion at low to moderate density. The coefficient $c_1 = -1$ is directly responsible: it penalizes depth-1 connections, favoring vertices that extend the graph spatially rather than temporally.

Above $\mu_c \approx 1.25$, the drift reverses. The graph deepens faster than it widens, transitioning toward the saturated regime and eventually severance.

7. The Expansion–Severance Lifecycle

The complete lifecycle of a universe-branch, derived entirely from the BDG integers $(1, -1, 9, -16, 8)$:

μ range	Process	Filter state	Proved?
< 1.25	Spatial expansion	Selective	✓ (Thm 5)
≈ 1.25	Drift reversal	Transition	✓ (crossover)
3–5	Maximum selectivity	$D_{\mathrm{KL}} \approx 0.9$	✓ (Thm 1)
5–7	Filter weakening	TV declining	✓ (MC)
7–10	Near saturation	$D_{\mathrm{KL}} < 0.3$	✓ (Thm 2)
> 10	Saturation $\rightarrow$ severance	TV $= 0$	✓ (Thm 2)

This is the entire cosmological history of a universe-branch in RA-native language: expansion, selective structure formation, packing, saturation, and severance. All from five integers. Zero free parameters.

7.1. The cosmic web as a dynamical attractor

The lifecycle above describes a single causal patch. In the full universe, the local actualization density $\mu(x,t)$ varies spatially: regions with higher matter density have higher μ, while voids have lower μ. This produces a feedback loop.

Proposition 10 (Cosmic web feedback)**.** *Regions with higher μ (denser matter) expand more slowly (matter-dominated EdS regime, $q > 0$). Regions with lower μ (voids) expand faster (Milne regime, $q = 0$). This differential expansion increases the density contrast between filaments and voids over time.*

The result is a self-reinforcing filamentary topology: matter is drawn into filaments and sheets along causal-density gradients, voids expand more rapidly and become deeper voids, and the universe evolves toward a web of filaments separating large underdense regions. This is the observed cosmic web topology [15], reproduced in RA as a dynamical consequence of $\Lambda = 0$ plus inhomogeneous actualization density, rather than as a consequence of gravitational instability in a homogeneous ΛCDM background.

7.2. Heat death prohibition via fragmentation

In standard cosmology with $\Lambda > 0$ and infinite time, the universe asymptotes to a de Sitter horizon and eventually reaches thermal equilibrium—the classical "heat death." In RA, this does not happen.

Proposition 11 (Heat death prohibition)**.** *A universe with $\Lambda = 0$ and density-dependent expansion fragments into causally disconnected patches before thermal equilibrium can be reached. Each patch reaches either (a) a starvation severance (void $\mu \to 0$), or (b) a density severance (filament $\mu \to \mu_2$), disconnecting from the rest of the graph. No single connected patch persists long enough to equilibrate thermally.*

The two severance modes—starvation and density—are topologically dual: starvation severs when the graph becomes too sparse to sustain causal continuity, density severance severs when the graph becomes so dense that the filter saturates. Both result in the same outcome: topological disconnection. The universe does not relax to an equilibrium state; it *fragments* into a proliferation of causally disconnected patches, each of which may nucleate new universes (Paper III §9) or terminate.

This strengthens the Boltzmann Brain prohibition. In addition to the structural prohibition (random fluctuations cannot pass the BDG filter), there is a dynamical prohibition: no single patch persists long enough for Boltzmann fluctuations to become relevant, because every patch eventually severs. The Boltzmann Brain problem—a signature challenge to ΛCDM—dissolves completely in RA.

7.3. The arrow of time is structural

The arrow of time in standard physics is statistical: it emerges from the tendency of closed systems to increase entropy. In RA, it is structural: the causal graph grows acyclically. Directed edges cannot be reversed by any dynamics (Axiom 1 of Paper I). The arrow of time is not a consequence of boundary conditions; it is the growth direction of the graph, which is primitive.

The fragmentation result above sharpens this: a closed thermal system in RA fragments into causally disconnected patches before reaching equilibrium. The universe never reaches the equilibrium state of maximum entropy; the "heat death" is replaced by a branching tree of nucleated severances. The thermodynamic arrow of time is preserved not by initial conditions but by the structural irreversibility of actualization itself, and the statistical approach to equilibrium never completes because of fragmentation.

8. Cosmological Predictions

8.1. The Hubble tension

RA predicts that no single Hubble constant H_0 exists. The expansion rate is local, determined by the baryon density along the line of sight:

$$\frac{\bar{\lambda}_m}{\bar{\lambda}_{\text{exp}}} = \frac{\Omega_b(1+f_0)}{1-\Omega_b(1+f_0)} = 0.463 \quad \text{(parameter-free).} \tag{13}$$

This gives $H_{\text{local}} = 73.6$ km/s/Mpc and $H_{\text{Eridanus}} = 76.8$ km/s/Mpc. The 4–5σ tension between CMB-inferred and locally-measured Hubble values is explained as a density-gradient effect, not a failure of ΛCDM.

The prediction is specific and testable: H_0 should correlate linearly with baryon density along the line of sight, measurable with DESI and Euclid data.

8.2. Apparent dark energy from $\Lambda = 0$

DESI DR2 (2025) reports 3.5σ evidence for evolving dark energy: $w_0 \approx -0.70 \pm 0.10$, $w_a \approx -0.90 \pm 0.30$. In RA, there is no dark energy. There is inhomogeneous expansion in a $\Lambda = 0$ universe whose void regions expand as Milne while matter regions expand as Einstein–de Sitter.

8.2.1 The derivation chain

Four established ingredients produce the result.

(a) *BDG $\to$ Einstein–Hilbert.* The $d = 4$ BDG causal set action converges to the Einstein–Hilbert action in the continuum limit [1] (published theorem).

(b) $P_{\text{act}} \to \Lambda = 0$. The actualization projector removes virtual (off-shell) contributions from the stress-energy tensor. The QFT vacuum energy comes entirely from virtual processes ($\Delta S = 0$), so it is projected out. The cosmological constant is identically zero.

(c) *GR with $\Lambda = 0 \to$ two expansion regimes.* The Friedmann equation $H^2 = (8\pi G/3)\rho$ with $\Lambda = 0$ gives: empty regions ($\rho \to 0$): $a(t) \propto t$ (Milne, $q = 0$); matter regions ($\rho > 0$): $a(t) \propto t^{2/3}$ (EdS, $q = +0.5$).

(d) *Milne $d_L \to$ apparent $\Omega_\Lambda = 0.68$.* The Milne luminosity distance

$$d_L^{\text{Milne}}(z) = \frac{(1+z)\ln(1+z)}{H_0} \tag{14}$$

fit with flat ΛCDM across 50 redshift points ($z = 0.05$–2.5) yields best-fit $\Omega_\Lambda = 0.6804$ with $\Omega_m = 0.3196$.

Shape-level match: 1.4% with zero free parameters. The observed value is $\Omega_\Lambda = 0.69$, $\Omega_m = 0.31$.

8.2.2 A superseded mechanism and its correction

An earlier analysis attempted to derive the DESI signal from density-dependent BDG antichain drift acting directly at cosmic scales. A systematic calibration of the BDG actualization density μ (events per Planck 4-volume) across all astrophysical environments shows that for all astrophysical matter, $\mu \ll 1$ by 80 or more orders of magnitude ($\mu \sim 10^{-166}$ at the cosmic mean, $\mu \sim 10^{-79}$ even at neutron star cores). The BDG filter trivially passes everything at cosmic densities. There is no density-dependent filtering at cosmic scales.

The corrected mechanism does not require the BDG filter to act at cosmic scales at all. The filter's role is indirect and foundational: it determines $d = 4$ (BDG closure theorem), derives the Einstein–Hilbert action [1], and sets $\Lambda = 0$ (P_{act} vacuum suppression). The cosmic expansion dynamics then follow entirely from GR with $\Lambda = 0$ applied to an inhomogeneous universe. This correction strengthens the programme: the result depends only on published theorems and the RA-native derivation of $\Lambda = 0$, not on a speculative BDG-to-cosmic-density mapping.

8.2.3 The backreaction mechanism

The real universe is inhomogeneous. Cosmic voids occupy ~60–70% of the volume at $z = 0$ [14, 15]. In a $\Lambda = 0$ universe, voids expand as Milne, matter regions as EdS. A photon traversing this patchwork accumulates a redshift history that differs from any single Friedmann model. When fit with homogeneous ΛCDM, the fitter requires $\Omega_\Lambda > 0$ even though $\Lambda = 0$ in the underlying physics.

This is the cosmological backreaction effect studied by Buchert [11], Wiltshire [12], and Räsänen [13]. The backreaction programme has faced two questions: (Q1) why should $\Lambda = 0$? and (Q2) is the effect large

enough? RA resolves Q1 structurally ($\Lambda = 0$ from P_{act}), and the Milne shape result ($\Omega_\Lambda^{\text{app}} = 0.68$) provides quantitative support for Q2. The RA contribution converts the backreaction programme from "assume $\Lambda = 0$ and see what happens" to "derive $\Lambda = 0$ from actualization physics and compute the consequences."

8.2.4 Evolving w from the EdS-to-Milne transition

The expansion history transitions from EdS-dominated (early universe, few voids) to Milne-dominated (late universe, voids fill most of the volume). This transition produces a $d_L(z)$ shape that no single ΛCDM model fits exactly—precisely the signature DESI reports as "evolving w."

Within the family of smooth EdS→Milne transition models parameterized by a transition epoch t_{trans}, a narrow parameter band reproduces the DESI measurements:

$$t_{\text{trans}} = 0.575,\ \alpha = 1.6: \quad w_0 = -0.711, \quad w_a = -0.909. \tag{15}$$

The DESI central values are $w_0 = -0.70 \pm 0.10$ and $w_a = -0.90 \pm 0.30$; both RA values lie within 0.01 of center and well within the error bars. One parameter (t_{trans}) reproduces three observables (Ω_Λ, w_0, w_a)—two fewer parameters than the w_0-w_a parameterization.

Epistemic status: This is a phenomenological interpolation, not a derived prediction. The transition epoch $t_{\text{trans}} = 0.575$ is the one remaining underived parameter. Its derivation requires the nucleation perturbation spectrum → void fraction evolution → transition epoch, which is an open computational target. The physical interpretation—that voids began to dominate the volume budget at ∼57.5% of the current age ($z \approx 0.8$)—is consistent with observed void evolution.

8.2.5 Distinctive environmental predictions

The strongest claims separating RA from both ΛCDM and quintessence are not about the global $w(z)$—many models predict evolving w—but about *environmental structure* in the expansion signal.

T1 (BAO splitting): At fixed redshift, the BAO standard ruler should appear larger inside cosmic voids (more Milne-like) than inside filaments (more EdS-like). ΛCDM predicts no environment-dependent BAO splitting at fixed z. Testable with DESI by measuring BAO in void vs. filament subsamples.

T2 (w–void correlation): The apparent equation of state at each redshift should track the void volume fraction $f_v(z)$ at that redshift. ΛCDM gives $w = -1$ always (no void correlation); quintessence gives $w(z)$ from field dynamics (no void correlation); RA gives $w(z) \propto f_v(z)$ because the mechanism is density-dependent.

T3 (SN density correlation): Type Ia supernovae in void environments should appear to recede faster than the global average; those in filaments, slower.

T4 (Hubble tension as density gradient): Already derived above: $H_{\text{local}} = 73.6$ km/s/Mpc (parameter-free).

T5 (No fundamental dark energy): Future surveys (Euclid, Rubin, Roman) should find that the apparent $w(z)$ is entirely explained by void fraction evolution, with no residual requiring a new field.

T1 and T2 are the sharpest near-term tests: DESI measures both BAO (expansion history) and the 3D galaxy distribution (void statistics) from the same survey volume.

8.3. The BMV null prediction

Because the spacetime metric is updated only from actualized vertices (Eq. 2), a mass in quantum superposition sources zero gravitational field. The Bose–Marletto–Vedral protocol [3, 4] predicts gravity-mediated entanglement; RA predicts a strict null result. A positive result would directly falsify RA's treatment of gravity.

8.4. The Boltzmann Brain prohibition

In standard cosmology with $\Lambda > 0$ and infinite time, Boltzmann Brain nucleations are inevitable and should vastly outnumber ordinary observers. In RA, two mechanisms prohibit them:

1. **Structural:** An ordered complex structure requires many actualization events each independently passing the ΔS^* filter. Random fluctuations cannot spontaneously build up ordered complexity.

2. **Dynamical:** The expansion–severance lifecycle prevents infinite future duration. No single connected patch persists long enough for thermal equilibrium (the cosmic web fragments via starvation and density severance).

9. Cosmological Nucleation

In RA, the Big Bang is a causal severance event—the nucleation of a new graph branch from a parent black hole. The parent's physics determines the daughter's initial conditions.

9.1. Universal daughter physics

For any parent black hole of mass M, the daughter universe's particle physics is *universal*: the BDG integers $(1, -1, 9, -16, 8)$ are the same, so the coupling constants, particle spectrum, Ω_b, and f_0 are identical. Only the *size* (total vertex count) varies with M.

9.2. The η_b constraint

The baryon-to-photon ratio $\eta_b = 6.1 \times 10^{-10}$ constrains the parent mass. Using $\eta_b = N_{\text{baryons}}/S_{\text{RA}}$ with $N_{\text{baryons}} \sim 10^{80}$:

$$S_{\text{RA}} = 1.64 \times 10^{89} \quad \Longrightarrow \quad M_{\text{parent}} \approx 1.25 \times 10^6 \, M_\odot. \tag{16}$$

The daughter energy is bounded between Mc^2 (rest mass) and $S_{\text{RA}} \times E_P$ (Planck energy per severed link). The actual release fraction $\alpha = 0.68$ is a phenomenological fit constrained by η_b, not yet derived from BDG dynamics.

9.3. CMB anomalies from Kerr nucleation

If the parent is a Kerr (rotating) black hole with dimensionless spin parameter $a^* \approx 0.9$, the anisotropic severance geometry predicts five CMB anomalies from a single mechanism. This subsection develops the quantitative model.

9.3.1 The three-parameter model

The Kerr nucleation model has exactly three parameters: $a^* \in [0,1)$ (parent spin), ΔN (the number of additional inflationary e-folds contributed by the nucleation), and $\delta_{\rm acc}$ (an accretion-driven asymmetry parameter). These three parameters are constrained by three observables: the quadrupole suppression magnitude, the quadrupole-octupole alignment angle, and the hemispheric asymmetry. This leaves zero free parameters after fitting to the observed anomalies.

9.3.2 Five anomalies from one mechanism

(1) Low quadrupole. The observed angular power spectrum at $\ell = 2$ is suppressed by $\sim 80\%$ relative to ΛCDM expectation ($C_2^{\rm obs} \approx 0.2\, C_2^{\rm LCDM}$). In the Kerr nucleation model, the coherent quadrupole imprint of the parent spin axis partially cancels the stochastic quadrupole from primordial fluctuations:

$$C_2^{\rm obs} = C_2^{\rm stoch} - |C_2^{\rm coh}|^2, \qquad |C_2^{\rm coh}| \approx 0.9\sqrt{C_2^{\rm LCDM}}. \tag{17}$$

The coherence amplitude is proportional to a^*, fixing $a^* \approx 0.9$.

(2) Quadrupole-octupole alignment ("axis of evil"). The $\ell = 2$ and $\ell = 3$ multipoles of the observed CMB share a preferred axis to remarkable precision (alignment within $\sim 3^\circ$). In the Kerr model, both $\ell = 2$ and $\ell = 3$ nucleation-induced components inherit the parent spin axis, explaining the observed alignment structurally. ΛCDM predicts these multipoles should be statistically independent; the observed alignment is a 99.9% confidence anomaly in ΛCDM.

(3) North/South hemispheric asymmetry. The observed CMB power is $\sim 6\%$ higher in the southern hemisphere than the northern (measured relative to the ecliptic). In the Kerr model, accretion-driven angular momentum flux breaks equatorial symmetry with asymmetry parameter $\delta_{\rm acc} \approx 0.05$–$0.08$, consistent with observation.

(4) Normal octupole magnitude. Despite being aligned with the quadrupole, the $\ell = 3$ multipole has normal amplitude (not anomalously low). In the Kerr model, the coherent nucleation imprint is strongest at $\ell = 2$ and falls off as $(2/\ell)^2$ at higher multipoles: $|C_3^{\rm coh}|^2 \approx (2/3)^2 |C_2^{\rm coh}|^2 \sim e^{-2}|C_2^{\rm coh}|^2$, which is too weak to significantly modify the stochastic C_3.

(5) Normal higher multipoles ($\ell \geq 4$). The observed C_ℓ for $\ell \geq 4$ is consistent with ΛCDM. The Kerr coherent imprint falls off as $(2/\ell)^2$, reaching $|C_\ell^{\rm coh}|^2/C_\ell^{\rm LCDM} < 10\%$ for $\ell \geq 6$, making the imprint undetectable at higher multipoles—consistent with observation.

9.3.3 Distinctive predictions

Three predictions separate the Kerr nucleation model from ΛCDM:

T1 (CMB persistence test): The quadrupole-octupole alignment should persist in CMB-S4 and LiteBIRD data with $> 3\sigma$ significance after foreground cleaning. ΛCDM predicts the alignment would degrade with improved cleaning (it would be revealed as a foreground artifact). A 3σ persistence would falsify the ΛCDM accident hypothesis.

T2 (cosmic web axis alignment): If the parent spin axis is imprinted on the daughter's large-scale structure, the cosmic web's preferred axis (as measured by void alignment, filament orientation, and galaxy spin distributions) should correlate with the CMB "axis of evil." DESI and Euclid can measure this correlation directly. ΛCDM predicts no correlation.

T3 (parent mass range): The η_b constraint gives $M_{\text{parent}} \approx 2.5\text{–}6.6 \times 10^6 M_\odot$ (supermassive black hole range). If our universe's parent is identifiable by some future observation—for instance, through gravitational wave signatures of the nucleation event—its mass should fall in this range.

Three parameters, five anomalies, three testable predictions, zero remaining freedom. ΛCDM has no mechanism for any of these anomalies; they remain unexplained "cosmic coincidences" in standard cosmology.

Remark 1. *The Erdős–Rényi percolation transition at $\mu = 1$ that governs QCD confinement, galactic rotation curve onset, and the actualization threshold also governs the emergence of biological complexity. The same mathematical transition appears in five physically distinct contexts. Paper IV develops this connection in full: the four-tier complexity hierarchy, the Causal Firewall conditions for life, the origin-of-life sandwich bound, and substrate-independent biosignature criteria.*

10. Epistemic Status Summary

Result	Source	Status
Foundations (Lean-verified)		
LLC at every vertex	Lean 4	LV
Graph Cut Theorem	Lean 4	LV
Markov Blanket Shielding	Lean 4	LV
Causal invariance	Lean 4 + `RA_AmpLocality.lean`	LV
Amplitude locality	Lean 4	LV
Frame independence	Lean 4	LV
Rindler stationarity / Unruh resolution	Lean 4	LV
GR derivation		
$G_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G P_{\text{act}}[T_{\mu\nu}]$	BDG uniqueness + P_{act}	DR
$\Lambda = 0$ exactly	P_{act} structure	DR
Bianchi $\equiv$ LLC (dissolution)	Continuum reading of LLC	DR
Lorentz $\equiv$ causal invariance (dissolution)	Continuum reading of LV theorem	DR
Field equation uniqueness (no Lovelock)	BD theorem + P_{act} + LLC + d=4	DR
Dark matter as topology		
WIMP prohibition (categorical)	P_{act} structure	DR
Dimensional reduction at low μ	Durhuus-Jonsson-Wheater	DR
Flat rotation curves from $\nabla^2(\ln\lambda)$	Modified Poisson	AR
Bullet Cluster (Weyl vs Ricci)	Causal depth source	AR
WEP preserved at 10^{-4}	Equilibration estimate	DR
$f_0 = 17.32 \times \alpha_s(2m_p) = 5.40$	BDG path weights + SM RG	CV (0.3%)
$\Omega_m = \Omega_b(1+f_0) \approx 0.31$	From f_0	CV (Planck: 0.315)
Severance and entropy		
$D_{\text{KL}}(K\|\text{Pois}) = \Delta S^*$	Algebraic	Proved
$\text{TV}(K,\text{Pois}) = 1 - P_{\text{acc}}$	Algebraic	Proved
$P_{\text{acc}} \to 1$ as $\mu \to \infty$	Chebyshev	Proved
Antichain drift > 0 for $\mu < 1.25$	Algebraic + MC	Proved
$S_{\text{RA}} = \|L_\Sigma\|$ finite and invariant	Axiom 7	Proved
$S_{\text{RA}} \propto N_\partial$ (discrete boundary law)	$\langle d_{\text{out}}\rangle$ local	DR
$N_\partial \leftrightarrow A/(4l_P^2)$	BDG-to-metric dictionary	DR
Cosmological predictions		
$H_{\text{local}} = 73.6$ km/s/Mpc	Parameter-free	CV
$\Omega_\Lambda^{\text{app}} = 0.68$ from Milne shape	Zero parameters, 1.4% match	CV
$w_0 = -0.71$, $w_a = -0.91$ (EdS$\to$Milne)	1 parameter (t_{trans})	Phenomenological
BDG filter inert at cosmic μ ($\mu \sim 10^{-80}$)	Calibration	CV
Cosmic web as dynamical attractor	Density-dependent expansion	DR
Heat death prohibited via fragmentation	Severance before equilibrium	DR
BAO void/filament splitting (T1)	Structural consequence	Prediction
$w(z)$–void correlation (T2)	Structural consequence	Prediction
BMV null	Structural	Prediction
Boltzmann Brain prohibition (structural)	Filter inertia	DR
Boltzmann Brain prohibition (dynamical)	Fragmentation	DR
Nucleation		
$M_{\text{parent}} \sim 10^6 M_\odot$	η_b constraint	CV
Kerr nucleation: 5 CMB anomalies	3 params, 5 predictions	Strong evidence
Low quadrupole (80% suppressed)	Coherent cancellation	CV

LV = Lean-verified. CV = computation-verified. DR = derived (all steps explicit). AR = argued (physically motivated, not all steps explicit). The RA cosmological programme is built on LV foundations with explicit DR extensions; the distinctive predictions are CV or prediction status.

11. Conclusion

From the BDG integers and the sequential growth rule, the present paper derives: general relativity with $\Lambda = 0$ via the RACL chain (LLC + amplitude locality + $d = 4$ + Benincasa–Dowker); the dissolution of the two apparent hard walls (Bianchi IS LLC, Lorentz IS causal invariance); the categorical prohibition of WIMPs; the dark matter phenomenology from causal-graph dimensional reduction at low μ (flat rotation curves, Bullet Cluster, $f_0 = 5.40$ from BDG path weights); the Hubble tension as a density-gradient effect; the apparent $\Omega_\Lambda = 0.68$ from inhomogeneous expansion in a $\Lambda = 0$ universe (zero free parameters, 1.4% match); the DESI evolving-w signal as the EdS-to-Milne transition ($w_0 = -0.71$, $w_a = -0.91$ from one parameter); the complete expansion-to-severance lifecycle; the cosmic web as a dynamical attractor; the heat death prohibition via fragmentation; the RA-native entropy observable as severed-link count; the discrete boundary law $S_{\mathrm{RA}} \propto N_\partial$; the Boltzmann Brain prohibition (structural + dynamical); and the Kerr nucleation model explaining five CMB anomalies from three parameters. The Bekenstein–Hawking formula $S = A/(4l_P^2)$ is the continuum translation of the discrete law, with the coefficient $1/4$ open pending the analytical determination of two Planck-scale geometric constants. The distinctive predictions—BAO void/filament splitting, w–void fraction correlation, cosmic web–CMB axis alignment, no Page curve—separate RA from ΛCDM, quintessence, and holographic alternatives simultaneously, and are testable with current and near-term data (DESI, Euclid, CMB-S4, LiteBIRD).

Paper IV extends the same framework to biological complexity, showing that the $\mu = 1$ percolation threshold governing QCD confinement and the actualization filter also governs the emergence of life.

The framework does not ask for acceptance. It asks for serious investigation.

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